

From: Errol Hendrickse errolhendrickse@icloud.com
Subject: Biography
Date: 5 Aug 2026 at 20:43:07
To: Michael Matley michaelrmatley@outlook.com

Errol Hendrickse

Errol Hendrickse is a British contemporary artist whose work explores the intersections of memory, identity, psychological resilience and the human condition. Through expressive abstraction and figurative painting, he investigates the fragile space between what is seen and what is experienced, creating paintings that speak to both personal and universal narratives.

Originally trained in Textile Design in the early 1990s, Hendrickse developed an early appreciation for structure, rhythm and surface. Although his career later moved away from the visual arts, the discipline of drawing, composition and material experimentation remained central to his creative thinking. Following many years working as a psychotherapist, he returned to painting with a renewed understanding of human emotion and the complexities of psychological experience. This convergence of artistic and therapeutic practice has become the foundation of his visual language.

Working predominantly in oil, charcoal and mixed media, Hendrickse builds his paintings through an intuitive process of layering, erasure, reconstruction and mark-making. Rather than working from fixed compositions, he allows forms to emerge gradually from movement, creating surfaces that retain the history of their making. Every line, scrape, stain and revision remains visible, allowing the painting to become both image and record of experience.

His abstract works are characterised by sweeping gestural marks, looping structures and dynamic compositions that suggest movement, tension and transformation. These works do not seek to describe specific places or events but instead evoke emotional states and the invisible architecture of thought and memory. They invite viewers to navigate ambiguity, encouraging individual interpretation rather than prescribed meaning.

Alongside his abstract practice, Hendrickse has developed a distinctive series of monochromatic portraits that explore themes of masculinity, vulnerability and emotional silence. Emerging from layers of charcoal blacks, muted greys and restrained whites, these figures appear simultaneously present and dissolving, embodying the tension between visibility and concealment. Sparse interventions of colour function as moments of psychological interruption rather than decoration, reflecting emotional fractures, resilience and hope.

His more recent figurative paintings extend this dialogue through a richer palette, examining identity, cultural heritage and belonging. While visually different, these works remain intrinsically connected to the abstract paintings, sharing the same gestural vocabulary and commitment to emotional authenticity. Across both bodies of work, abstraction and representation are not opposing languages but complementary expressions of the same enquiry.

Central to Hendrickse's practice is an interest in process. Painting is understood as an act of discovery rather than illustration, where uncertainty is embraced as an essential part of creation. Surfaces evolve through continual negotiation between control and spontaneity, allowing unexpected relationships to emerge. The resulting works possess an immediacy that reflects both the physical act of painting and the psychological landscapes from which they arise.

Drawing upon a lifetime of personal and professional experience, Hendrickse's work reflects an enduring belief in the capacity of art to communicate what language often cannot. Rather than offering definitive narratives, his paintings create spaces for contemplation, empathy and connection. They ask viewers to slow down, to look beyond appearances and to encounter the emotional complexities that unite us all.

Today, Hendrickse continues to develop interconnected bodies of abstract and figurative work from his studio, exploring the evolving relationship between gesture, memory and the human experience. His practice remains driven by the conviction that painting is not simply the representation of life but a means of understanding it.

Errol Hendrickse
errolhendrickse@icloud.com
[07950192882](tel:07950192882)